

Chapter 6 — Dhyāna Yoga

ध्यानयोगः : ధ్యానయోగము

"The Yoga of Meditation" · 47 verses · The climax of Part I — stillness of mind

After teaching karma-yoga, jñāna-yoga, and inner renunciation, Kṛṣṇa now teaches the **practical method** for stilling the mind: **dhyāna** — meditation. He gives detailed instructions on posture, environment, diet, and discipline, but the heart of the chapter is psychological: **the mind is restless, but it can be trained**. The yogi becomes "*his own friend*" — not his own enemy. The chapter culminates in the unforgettable image: "*like a lamp in a windless place, the disciplined mind does not flicker*" (6.19).

Essential verses of Chapter 6

BG 6.5 Lift yourself by yourself — you are both your friend and your enemy

उद्धरेदात्मनात्मानं नात्मानमवसादयेत् ।

आत्मैव ह्यात्मनो बन्धुरात्मैव रिपुरात्मनः ॥ ६.५ ॥

ఉద్ధరేదాత్మనాత్మానం నాత్మానమవసాదయేత్ ।

ఆత్మైవ హ్యాత్మనో బంధురాత్మైవ రిపురాత్మనః ॥ ౬.౫ ॥

uddhared ātmanātmānam nātmānam avasādayet |

ātmaiva hy ātmano bandhur ātmaiva ripur ātmanah | |

"One should lift oneself by oneself — never let oneself sink.

For the self alone is the friend of the self,

and the self alone is the enemy of the self."

One of the most psychologically piercing verses in the Gītā.

Word-by-Word — 6.5 (be your own friend)

IAST	उद्धरेत्	आत्मना	उद्धरेत्	PRONUNCIATION	MEANING
<i>uddharet</i>	उद्धरेत्	आत्मना	उद्धरेत्	ud-DHA-ret	should lift up, raise, deliver
<i>ātmanā</i>	आत्मना	आत्मना	आत्मना	aat-ma-NAA	by the self / by oneself
<i>ātmānam</i>	आत्मानम्	आत्मानम्	आत्मानम्	aat-MAA-nam	the self / oneself (acc.)
<i>na avasādayet</i>	न अवसादयेत्	न अवसादयेत्	न अवसादयेत्	na a-va-SAA-da-yet	should not let sink, depress, degrade
<i>ātmā eva</i>	आत्मा एव	आत्मा एव	आत्मा एव	aat-MAA E-va	the self alone
<i>hi</i>	हि	हि	हि	hi	indeed
<i>ātmanah</i>	आत्मनः	आत्मनः	आत्मनः	AAT-ma-nah	of the self
<i>bandhuh</i>	बन्धुः	बन्धुः	बन्धुः	BAN-dhuh	friend, kinsman
<i>ripuh</i>	रिपुः	रिपुः	रिपुः	RI-puh	enemy

BG 6.19 *The lamp-in-a-windless-place simile — the disciplined mind*

यथा दीपो निवातस्थो नेङ्गते सोपमा स्मृता ।

योगिनो यतचित्तस्य युञ्जतो योगमात्मनः ॥ ६.१९ ॥

యథా దీపో నివాతస్థో నేంగతే సోపమా స్మృతా ।

యోగిన్ యతచిత్తస్య యుంజతో యోగమాత్మనః ॥ ౬.౧౯ ॥

yathā dīpo nivāta-stho neṅgate sopamā smṛtā |

yogino yata-cittasya yuñjato yogam ātmanah | |

"As a lamp in a windless place does not flicker —
so is the simile of the disciplined mind of the yogi
who practices the yoga of the Self."

The single most famous image of meditation in Indian literature.

BG 6.30 *The yogi sees Me everywhere, and Me sees him — never lost*

यो मां पश्यति सर्वत्र सर्वं च मयि पश्यति ।

तस्याहं न प्रणश्यामि स च मे न प्रणश्यति ॥ ६.३० ॥

యో మాం పశ్యతి సర్వత్ర సర్వం చ మయి పశ్యతి ।

తస్యాహం న ప్రణశ్యామి స చ మే న ప్రణశ్యతి ॥ ౬.౩౦ ॥

yo māṁ paśyati sarvatra sarvaṁ ca mayi paśyati |

tasyāhaṁ na praṇaśyāmi sa ca me na praṇaśyati | |

"One who sees Me everywhere, and sees all in Me —
for him I am never lost,
and he is never lost to Me."

A bridge verse — pointing forward to the devotional teachings of Part II.

□ Essential take-away of Chapter 6

Be your own friend.

No external savior can rescue you from the restlessness of your own mind. The same mind that drags you down can also lift you up — **if you train it**. Steady practice + dispassion (*abhyāsa* + *vairāgya*, 6.35) is the only formula.

Three things to remember:

1. **Self-effort matters most** (6.5) — you are both jailer and liberator.
2. **Moderation** (6.17) — neither over-eating nor fasting, neither over-sleeping nor wakefulness.
3. **A still mind** (6.19) — like a lamp in a windless place — is the goal.

□□□□□□□□

□□□□□□

IAST

Pronunciation

English